Yi Sui

Email: yisui.sui@mail.utoronto.ca Web: https://yi-sui.github.io/

EDUCATION

University of Toronto, Centre for Industrial Relations and Human Resources — Toronto, Canada
Ph.D. in Industrial Relations — 2026–Present

Renmin University of China, School of Labor and Human Resources — Beijing, China
M.A. in Labor Relations — 2024–2026
B.A. in Labor Relations (Minor in Public Administration) — 2020–2024

Korea University, Graduate School of Labor Studies — Seoul, Korea
Exchange Student — 2024 Spring

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on transnational labor governance and comparative industrial relations, with a particular interest in the maritime industry. I examine how international labor rules and institutions interact with governments and firms, and when these interactions strengthen or undermine the enforcement of labor standards. I investigate these questions through studies of port state control inspections under the ILO's Maritime Labour Convention, transnational collective bargaining, and labor provisions in trade agreements. I also examine how global supply chains shape working conditions in shipping.

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

[1] **Sui, Yi**, and Hao Zhang. 2026. "Fragmented Shores in International Waters: Coalitions and Discrimination in Port State Control's Labour Inspections." ***Journal of Industrial Relations***. https://doi.org/10.1177/00221856261481652.

- 2026 **UofSC-Douglas Nigh Best Paper in Multidisciplinary Research Award Finalist**, Academy of Management.
- 2026 **Best Paper Award (First Prize)**, Industrial Relations Committee of the China Association for Labor Studies.

[2] Liu, Mingwei, Hao Zhang, and **Yi Sui**. 2024. "Workplace Artificial Intelligence Regulation in China: Between Efficiency and Social Stability." ***ILR Review***, 77(5): 813-824.

Book Chapters

[1] Liu, Mingwei, and **Yi Sui**. 2027 (in press). "China's Governance of Artificial Intelligence: Domestic Ordering and Global Influence." In Li, Ji, and Gregory Shaffer (eds.), *China and Transnational Legal Ordering: Disaggregating the State*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press: Ch.12.

[2] Zhang, Hao, and **Yi Sui**. 2025. "Constructing the Knowledge System, Institutional System, and Talent System for Harmonious Labor Relations in China [in Chinese]." In Zhang, Hao (ed.), *China's Harmonious Labor Relations Development Report 2025*, Beijing, China: China Human Resources & Social Security Publishing Group.

[3] Sun, Zhaoyang, and **Yi Sui**. 2024. "Basic Regulations of the International Labour Organization on Employment [in Chinese]." In Gao, Wenshu (ed.), *Belt and Road Labor Market and Employment Practices of Overseas Chinese Firms*, Beijing, China: China Social Sciences Press: Ch.7.

Book Reviews

[1] Zhang, Hao, and **Yi Sui**. 2025. "Temporary and Gig Economy Workers in China and Japan: The Culture of Unequal Work." By Fu, Huiyan (ed.), Oxford University Press. *The China Journal*, 94(1): 177-179.

Popular Writings

[1] **Sui, Yi**. 2023. "Our Duty as Labor Studies Students [in Chinese]." *Memories of School of Labor and Human Resources*, 88-90.

[2] **Sui, Yi**. 2022. "Memories of a Winter Olympics Volunteer [in Chinese]." *Renmin University of China Newspaper Special Issue*, 36-39.

[3] **Sui, Yi**. 2022. "The May Fourth Movement and Chinese Youth [in Chinese]." *China Television Newspapers*, 17: A17.

WORKING PAPERS

[1] **Sui, Yi**. "Compliance by Contract: Collective Agreements and Institutional Arbitrage in Maritime Labor Inspections."
- 2025 **Regulating for Decent Work Conference Fellowship**, International Labour Organization.
- 2025 **Second Prize, Annual Conference Paper Competition**, Guangxi Maritime and Admiralty Law Research Association.

[2] **Sui, Yi**, and Hao Zhang. "The Paradox of State Affiliation: The All-China Federation of Trade Unions at an International Table."

[3] Liu, Mingwei, and **Yi Sui**. "China and Regulation of Artificial Intelligence." (December 06, 2025). Available at SSRN: https://ssrn.com/abstract=5874043

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

[1] **Sui, Yi**, and Hao Zhang. "Fragmented Shores in International Waters: Coalitions and Discrimination in Port State Control's Labor Inspections."
- 2026: CALS (China Association for Labor Studies) Industrial Relations Committee Annual Conference, Guangzhou, China.
- 2026: AOM (Academy of Management) Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, USA (Virtual).
- 2026: MPSA (Midwest Political Science Association) Annual Conference, Chicago, USA (Virtual).

[2] **Sui, Yi**, and Hao Zhang. "The Paradox of State Affiliation: The All-China Federation of Trade Unions at an International Table."
- 2026: MPSA (Midwest Political Science Association) Annual Conference, Chicago, USA (Virtual).
- 2025: APSA (American Political Science Association) Annual Meeting, Vancouver, Canada (Virtual).
- 2025: ICCPS (International Conference on China Policy Studies), Beijing, China.

[3] **Sui, Yi**. "Compliance by Contract: Collective Agreements and Institutional Arbitrage in Maritime Labor Inspections."
- 2026: Youth Scholars Forum on Harmonious Labor Relations, Beijing, China.
- 2026: MPSA (Midwest Political Science Association) Annual Conference, Chicago, USA (Virtual).
- 2025: ILO RDW (Regulating for Decent Work) Conference, Geneva, Switzerland.
- 2025: Camphor International Economics Conference, Beijing, China.
- 2025: ICCPS (International Conference on China Policy Studies), Beijing, China.
- 2025: IMBeR (Integrated Marine Biosphere Research) Synthesis and Future Planning Conference

(Future Oceans 3), Shanghai, China.

- 2025: Youth Academic Forum of the Business School, China University of Political Science and Law, Beijing, China.

[4] **Sui, Yi**, and Hao Zhang. "Can Technological Advances Prevent a Race to the Bottom? Institutional Provision and Shipowner Strategies for Seafarer Skill Formation in Smart Shipping."

- 2024: CSA (Chinese Sociological Association) Annual Meeting, Harbin, China.

[5] **Sui, Yi**. "Artificial Intelligence, Industrial Structures and Economic Growth: New Evidence from China's Patent Documents."

- 2023: Camphor International Economics Conference, Beijing, China.

[6] **Sui, Yi**. "Who is Paying the Bills? The Case of Small Island Developing States after the Initial IMO Strategy on Reduction of GHG Emissions from Ships."

- 2023: ILO Winter Global Youth Forum, Turin, Italy (Virtual).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, School of Labor and Human Resources, Renmin University of China

- Labor Relations (required undergraduate course), Prof. Hao Zhang — 2026 Spring
- History of Labor Relations (required undergraduate course), Prof. Chuling Huang — 2025 Fall
- People, Work, and Organization (English-taught course), Prof. Mingwei Liu — 2025 Summer
- Labor Relations (required undergraduate course), Prof. Hao Zhang — 2025 Spring
- Core Literature in Labor Relations (required doctoral course), Prof. Hao Zhang — 2024 Fall
- Seminar for Freshmen (undergraduate course), Prof. Hao Zhang — 2024 Fall

Project Adviser, School of Labor and Human Resources, Renmin University of China

- Research project on "Legal Protections for Chinese Digital Nomads Abroad", National University Student Innovation Program — 2026–2027
- Research project on "Working Conditions of Cross-Border Migrant Workers in Guangxi", National University Student Innovation Program — 2024–2025

RESEARCH GRANTS

Fieldwork Research Grant (C$5,000), Interuniversity Research Centre on Globalization and Work (CRIMT) — 2025

Undergraduate Research Fund (¥8,000; Completed with Distinction), Renmin University of China — 2023

Beijing Municipal Undergraduate Innovation Training Program (¥8,000), Renmin University of China — 2023

National Undergraduate Entrepreneurship Training Program (¥5,000), Renmin University of China — 2022

SELECTED AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Connaught International Scholarship (C$10,000/year), University of Toronto — 2026–2030

Doctoral Recruitment Award (C$10,000), University of Toronto — 2026

UofSC-Douglas Nigh Best Paper Award Finalist, Academy of Management — 2026

Best Paper (First Prize), Industrial Relations Committee of the China Association for Labor Studies — 2026

Wu Yuzhang Scholarship (¥10,000), Renmin University of China — 2026

- Highest university-wide student honor at Renmin University of China

Merit Student, Beijing Municipal Commission of Education — 2026

Regulating for Decent Work Conference Fellowship (CHF2,000), International Labour Organization — 2025

National Scholarship (¥20,000), China's Ministry of Education — 2025

- Selected as Renmin University's sole National Scholarship recipient featured in *People's Daily*

First-Class Graduate Academic Scholarship (¥12,000/year), Renmin University of China 2024, 2025
Outstanding Graduate of Beijing, Beijing Municipal Commission of Education 2024, 2026
Second Prize for Research Paper, Guangxi Maritime Law Association Annual Meeting 2025
Nominee for the Wu Yuzhang Scholarship, Renmin University of China 2024
President's Fellowship (¥30,000), Renmin University of China 2024
Global Korea University Scholarship (₩250,000), Korea University 2024
Jingdong Premium Scholarship for Outstanding Students (¥10,000), Renmin University of China 2023
Undergraduate Academic Scholarship (¥10,000 total), Renmin University of China 2021, 2022, 2023
Merit Student, Renmin University of China 2021, 2022, 2023, 2025
Dahua International Exchange Fellowship (¥10,000), Dahua Education Fund 2023
Outstanding Student Leader Scholarship (¥2,000), Renmin University of China 2022
Social Work and Volunteer Service Scholarship (¥2,000), Renmin University of China 2021

WORKING EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, School of Labor and Human Resources, Renmin University of China 2022–2026
Forum Assistant, Annual Global Labor Governance Forum, Renmin University of China 2025
Research Assistant, School of Global Education and Development, University of Chinese Academy of Social Sciences 2023–2024
Symposium Assistant, "Technologies and Work, Research Methods, Publication and Discipline Construction" Symposium, The 40th Anniversary of the SLHR 2023
Research Assistant, National Academy of Development and Strategy, Renmin University of China 2022–2023

SELECTED EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Volunteer, Olympic Winter Games Beijing 2022, Beijing, China 2021–2022
Volunteer, Second United Nations Global Sustainable Transport Conference, Beijing, China 2021
Class Monitor, School of Labor and Human Resources, Renmin University of China 2022–2024
Registered Volunteer, China Marrow Donor Program 2021–Present
Blood donor (1,700 mL donated) 2021–Present

SKILLS

Coding: Stata, SPSS, Python
Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native), Korean (beginner)

REFERENCES

- **Greg Distelhorst**
  Associate Professor
  Centre for Industrial Relations and Human Resources
  University of Toronto
  Email: g.distelhorst@utoronto.ca
- **Hao Zhang**
  Professor & Chair, Department of Labor Relations
  School of Labor and Human Resources
  Renmin University of China
  Email: zhang-hao@ruc.edu.cn

Last updated: October 2026